

QUICK GUIDE · PROGRAMS FOR VETERANS

Benefits for Family & Survivors

Your service earned benefits for your family too — and survivors of veterans who died from service may qualify for monthly income, health care, and education. Below are the key resources. Tick the box once you've checked each one.

⚠ BEFORE YOU START

These benefits are often missed by grieving families. They're free to apply for — a VSO can help at no cost. If a veteran's death was service-connected, survivors may qualify for tax-free monthly payments.

1 Monthly Income for Survivors

Tax-free payments for eligible surviving family.

☐ Dependency & Indemnity Compensation (DIC)

Tax-free monthly payment for survivors of veterans who died from a service-connected cause.

→ www.va.gov/disability/dependency-indemnity-compensation

☐ Survivors Pension

Tax-free monthly income for low-income surviving spouses/children of wartime veterans.

→ www.va.gov/pension/survivors-pension

2 Health Coverage for Family

Coverage for spouses and children in many cases.

☐ CHAMPVA

Health coverage for families of permanently disabled veterans or those who died from service.

→ www.va.gov/health-care/family-caregiver-benefits/champva 1-800-733-8387

3 Education for Family

Help paying for your family's schooling.

☐ Fry Scholarship

Post-9/11 GI Bill benefits for children/spouses of those who died in the line of duty.

→ www.va.gov/education/survivor-dependent-benefits/fry-scholarship

☐ Survivors' & Dependents' Education (DEA)

Education and training benefits for families of certain veterans.

→ www.va.gov/education/survivor-dependent-benefits/dependents-education-assistance

4 Other Support

Home loans, memorials, and free help applying.

☐ Home Loan for Surviving Spouses

Some surviving spouses qualify for a VA home loan with no down payment.

→ www.va.gov/housing-assistance/home-loans/surviving-spouse

☐ Burial & Memorial Benefits

Help with burial, headstones, and memorial benefits for veterans.

→ www.va.gov/burials-memorials

⚠ WATCH OUT FOR

Be cautious of anyone charging to help survivors “claim” VA benefits — accredited VSOs help free. Apply even years later; some survivor benefits can be claimed well after a veteran’s passing.

★ A TIP THAT HELPS

If you’re a surviving spouse or child, talk to a free VSO about DIC, CHAMPVA, and education benefits together — many families qualify for several at once but only ever apply for one.

NEED HELP WHERE YOU LIVE?

Need help where you live?

This guide covers national programs. For a VSO near you and help applying as a survivor, use the personalized AI search or ask in the Questions area.

MY NOTES — WHO I CALLED, WHEN, AND WHAT THEY SAID
